Byte Blitz: Official Game Rules

Game Overview

Byte Blitz is a chaotic, "Spoons"-style shedding and collection game designed to get high schoolers rapidly converting bases through pattern recognition and repetition. Students rapidly pass cards in a circle, racing to build a matching trio of equivalent values: one Binary, one Hexadecimal, and one Decimal card.

Setup Materials

For each group of 4 to 6 players, you will need:

- **Index cards in 3 different colors** (e.g., Blue for Binary, Red for Hexadecimal, Green for Decimal). You will need about 40-45 cards per deck.
- **Markers** to write values on the cards.
- **Physical tokens** (spoons, dry-erase markers, or rubber erasers). You need **one fewer token** than the number of players in a group.
- **Cheat sheet** (optional, for the dealer/referee to verify correct matches).

How to Play

1. Create the Deck

Create 13-15 sets of equivalent values across the three bases. Include a mix of easy nibbles (4-bit) and trickier full bytes (8-bit).

- *Example Set 1:* Blue Card: `1010` | Red Card: `A` | Green Card: `10`
- *Example Set 2:* Blue Card: `1111` | Red Card: `F` | Green Card: `15`
- *Example Set 3:* Blue Card: `1011 0101` | Red Card: `B5` | Green Card: `181`

2. Set Up the Table

1. Group students into pods of 4 to 6.
2. Place the physical tokens in the exact center of the table so they are equidistant from all players. **Remember: always place exactly one fewer token than there are players.**
3. Shuffle the deck thoroughly and deal exactly 3 cards to every player.

4. Place the remaining cards face-down next to the designated "Dealer" of the round.

3. The Pass (Continuous Play)

There are no turns in Byte Blitz; the game happens continuously and simultaneously.

- The Dealer draws one card from the deck, looks at it, and decides whether to keep it or pass it.
- Players must always maintain **exactly 3 cards** in their hand, so if they pick up a card, they must immediately slide one discarded card face-down to the player on their left.
- That next player picks up the passed card, evaluates it, and passes one of their cards to the left.
- The last player in the circle places their discarded cards into a "Trash" pile.
- The Dealer continues pulling from the deck and passing as fast as they can.

4. The Grab

Silent recognition is key. As cards fly around the circle, players are hunting for a matching trio (e.g., holding 1111, F, and 15 simultaneously).

- As soon as a player secures a valid trio, they must silently reach into the center and grab a token.
- Once the first token is taken, the round instantly becomes a free-for-all! Every other player must immediately dive to grab one of the remaining tokens, regardless of whether their hand matches.

5. Verification and Scoring

The player left without a token gets a "strike" (a letter, starting with H, then E, then X). Before the strike is recorded, the player who initiated the grab must reveal their hand.

- **If the math is correct:** The player who missed out gets the strike.
- **If the math is wrong (a false grab):** The initiating player gets the strike instead, and the round is restarted.
- Play continues until someone spells out H-E-X (or H-E-X-A-D-E-C-I-M-A-L for a longer game) or a set time limit is reached.

Action Cards Expansion (Optional)

To introduce chaos without breaking the fast-paced flow, shuffle 4 to 6 "Interrupt" cards into the main deck. When a player draws an action card, they can instantly play it by slapping it

face-up in the center of the table and shouting its name. All passing stops while the action resolves.

- **Bit Shift (Left or Right):** Everyone must instantly pass their entire three-card hand to the player next to them in the called direction.
- **Bit Flip (NOT):** The attacker points at any opponent. That opponent must discard their current hand and draw three new cards from the dealer.
- **Malware (The Hex):** Slide this card in front of an opponent. They are "infected" and can only win the round if their final matching trio represents an odd number.
- **Syntax Error:** The targeted player must play the remainder of the round with their non-dominant hand. Accidental use of their dominant hand results in a strike.
- **Format C:\ (Wipe):** The nuclear option. Every player (except the attacker) passes one random card from their hand to the center. The dealer shuffles and redistributes them randomly.